

Your Website as an AI Signal

Structure, schema, and the content that gets you cited by ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Google AI Overviews — the complete final module.

After this module: Your website will be structured so AI tools can identify who you are, what you do, and why you're the best local answer — and cite you in response to the searches that matter most.

What you'll learn in this module

This is the final module in the series — and in many ways, it's the one that ties everything else together. Your Google Business Profile, your citations, your reviews, your NAP consistency — all of those signals point AI tools towards your website when they're deciding whether to recommend you. What your website says when they arrive is what closes the deal.

- Why your website is an AI signal in its own right — and what it signals right now
- How to add LocalBusiness schema markup so AI tools understand exactly who and where you are
- The answer-first writing method that gets your content cited in AI responses
- How to build a FAQ section with FAQPage schema that AI tools quote directly
- The seven structural elements every local business homepage needs for AI visibility
- How to test whether AI tools are citing your website — and how to track improvement

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Read it once all the way through, then come back with your website open and implement each section one at a time. Most of this module can be acted on in a single afternoon — the results build over the following 4-8 weeks.

47%

more Perplexity citations for pages
with FAQPage schema

78%

of Google AI Overviews cite pages
with LocalBusiness schema

3x

more likely to be cited when
content leads with a direct answer

Why your website is the final piece of the puzzle

THINK OF IT THIS WAY

Imagine you're a talent scout — ChatGPT, in this case — and you've heard good things about a local plumber. Lots of consistent reviews, their name comes up in multiple directories, good Google profile. You go to their website to see if the information checks out. You find a generic homepage with no address visible, no specific services listed, and copy that reads "we provide a range of plumbing solutions across the local area." You're not sure what you're looking at. You pass.

That's what most local business websites are doing to AI tools right now. Not because the business isn't good — but because the website isn't structured to communicate clearly to a machine that's deciding in milliseconds whether to cite it.

In the previous four modules, we've built your Google Business Profile, fixed your citations, got your reviews in order, and understood how review signals influence AI. Now we're turning to the asset you control completely: your website. Unlike your GBP or directory listings, you can change your website right now — today — to immediately improve your AI visibility.

This module covers exactly what to change, how to change it, and why each element matters to the specific way AI tools process and cite local business information.

Section 1: What AI tools look for on your website

AI tools don't read websites the way humans do. They don't linger on beautiful design or notice your brand colours. They extract information — and they're remarkably good at it. The question is whether the information they extract about you is complete, accurate, and confident enough to act on.

There are three layers of information AI tools extract from your website:

Layer 1: Structured data (schema markup)

This is explicit, machine-readable information you embed directly in your page code. LocalBusiness schema tells AI tools: "this is a business called X, located at Y, providing these services, with this phone number." It's the clearest possible signal. AI tools prioritise structured data over inferred information every time.

Layer 2: On-page content signals

What does your homepage actually say? Is your business name, location, and service in the first paragraph? Are there headings that match the questions people actually ask about your trade? Is your content written so the answer comes first — not buried after three paragraphs of history?

Layer 3: Authority and trust signals

How many other credible sources link to or mention your website? Does your website mention specific, verifiable details (review counts, years in business, specific area coverage)? Does the content match what your GBP and directory listings say about you?

In this module, we're focusing almost entirely on Layers 1 and 2 — the things you can directly control and change. Layer 3 builds over time as a result of getting the first two right.

Section 2: LocalBusiness schema — your identity card for AI

THE ANALOGY

Schema markup is like handing an AI tool your business card, your accreditation certificate, and your address proof all at once — except it's in a language the AI reads instantly without having to interpret anything. Without it, the AI has to guess who you are from the surrounding text. With it, there's no guessing.

LocalBusiness schema is a block of code you add to your homepage (and ideally every service page) that gives AI tools structured, unambiguous information about your business. It's part of the Schema.org vocabulary — an agreed-upon standard that Google, Microsoft, and other AI companies all understand.

The good news: you don't need a developer to add it. It's a block of JSON code that goes between your `<script>` tags. If your website is on WordPress, there are plugins that generate it for you. If it's a custom site or a website builder, you add it yourself in under 10 minutes.

What LocalBusiness schema contains

- **Your business name** — exactly as it appears everywhere else
- **Business type** — the specific Schema.org category (e.g., Plumber, ElectricalContractor, Dentist)
- **Address** — your full address broken into structured fields
- **Phone number** — in international format (+44...)
- **Opening hours** — when you're open, in machine-readable format
- **Service area** — the towns and areas you cover
- **Rating** — your aggregate review score (from Google, if public)
- **Website URL and description** — what you do, in a sentence

A complete LocalBusiness schema example

Here's what a plumber in Birmingham would add to their homepage. Copy this, replace the values in brackets, and paste it inside a `<script type="application/ld+json">` tag in the `<head>` of your page:

LOCALBUSINESS SCHEMA — PASTE IN YOUR <HEAD>

```
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "Plumber", // ← change to your business type
  "name": "Smith Plumbing Ltd",
  "description": "Emergency plumber in Birmingham covering Moseley, Kings Heath and surrounding areas.",
  "telephone": "+44-121-000-0000",
  "url": "https://smithplumbing.co.uk",
  "address": {
    "@type": "PostalAddress",
    "streetAddress": "14 High Street",
    "addressLocality": "Birmingham",
    "postalCode": "B1 2AB",
    "addressCountry": "GB"
  },
  "areaServed": ["Birmingham", "Moseley", "Kings Heath"],
  "aggregateRating": {
    "@type": "AggregateRating",
    "ratingValue": "4.9",
    "reviewCount": "143"
  }
}
```

How to add LocalBusiness schema to your site

The method depends on how your website is built. Here's the step-by-step for the most common platforms:

WordPress

- 1 Install the free plugin **Yoast SEO** or **Rank Math** — both generate LocalBusiness schema automatically from your settings
- 2 In Yoast: go to SEO → Local SEO (may require free Local SEO plugin). In Rank Math: go to Rank Math → Schema → Local Business
- 3 Fill in your business name, address, phone, and type — the plugin generates the JSON-LD
- 4 Alternatively, use the **Schema Pro** plugin for manual control

Wix, Squarespace, or website builder

- 1 Go to your page settings and find "Custom Code" or "Header Code" section
- 2 Create a new code block, set it to load in the <head>
- 3 Paste your complete schema code wrapped in <script type="application/ld+json"> tags
- 4 Save and publish — the schema is now live on your homepage

Custom HTML site

- 1 Open your homepage HTML file
- 2 Find the <head> section (before the closing </head> tag)
- 3 Paste: <script type="application/ld+json">[your schema code]</script>
- 4 Save, upload, and verify with Google's Rich Results Test at search.google.com/test/rich-results

QUICK VERIFY

Section 3: The seven elements every AI-optimised homepage needs

Schema markup tells AI tools what you are. Your on-page content tells them how good you are and why you're relevant to a specific search. Both matter. Here are the seven elements your homepage needs — not for humans (though they help with humans too), but specifically because AI tools extract and evaluate each one.

Element 1: A direct opening statement

Your first paragraph should answer the question "who is this business and what do they do and where?" in one or two sentences. No preamble. No "welcome to our website." No history. The direct answer, immediately.

❑ WEAK — BURIES THE ANSWER

"Welcome to Smith Plumbing. We've been serving the local community for over 15 years, and we pride ourselves on our fast, reliable, and affordable service. Get in touch today to discuss your plumbing needs."

✓ STRONG — LEADS WITH THE ANSWER

"Smith Plumbing provides emergency plumbing and gas services across Birmingham — 24/7 callouts, 60-minute response, Gas Safe registered. Covering Moseley, Kings Heath, Harborne, and surrounding areas."

The second version gives AI tools everything they need in two sentences: who (Smith Plumbing), what (emergency plumbing and gas), where (Birmingham, specific areas), when (24/7), how fast (60 minutes), and a trust signal (Gas Safe registered).

Element 2: Visible NAP (Name, Address, Phone)

Your business name, full address, and phone number must appear as visible text on your homepage — not just in your footer image, not only in a contact form, but as readable HTML text that AI crawlers can extract. The address should match your GBP exactly.

COMMON MISTAKE

Many websites display their phone number as an image (to prevent scrapers) or as part of a clickable button with no surrounding text. AI tools can't read image text. Your phone number must be visible as actual HTML text somewhere on the page.

Element 3: Service area mentioned specifically

Don't write "we cover the local area" or "serving the West Midlands." Name the specific towns and neighbourhoods you serve. "Covering Birmingham, Solihull, Redditch, Bromsgrove, and Kidderminster" gives AI tools clear geographic context — and makes you a strong match for queries that include any of those place names.

Element 4: Specific services listed

Your services should be listed explicitly — ideally with their own headings or section on the page. Not "a wide range of plumbing services" but the actual services: "Emergency boiler repair, boiler installation, central heating, gas safety certificates, bathroom fitting, leak detection." Each service you name becomes a potential citation match for someone asking ChatGPT about that specific service in your area.

GO A LEVEL DEEPER

If you have separate service pages (e.g., a page just for boiler repair), add LocalBusiness schema with service-specific content to each one. That page becomes a direct citation source for "[service] in [your town]" searches — not just your homepage.

Element 5: Specific numbers and credentials

AI tools quote specific, verifiable facts. Vague claims like "we're experienced" and "our customers love us" provide nothing to cite. Replace them with specific data:

- Years in business: "Trading since 2008" or "17 years experience"
- Jobs completed: "Over 1,200 boiler installations"
- Review score: "4.9 stars from 143 Google reviews"
- Response time: "60-minute emergency callout guarantee"
- Qualifications: "Gas Safe registered (ID: 123456)" or "Rated NICEIC approved contractor"

Each of these becomes a citation anchor — a specific, quotable fact that AI tools can reference when recommending you.

Element 6: Question-format headings

At least some of your page headings should be written as questions your customers actually ask. "How quickly can you respond to an emergency?" "Do you cover my area?" "Are you Gas Safe registered?" These headings signal to AI tools exactly which question a section of content answers — making it a direct match for anyone asking that question to an AI.

Element 7: A FAQ section with schema

This is the single highest-impact element you can add. A FAQ section — with 5-8 real questions and direct answers — paired with FAQPage schema markup, creates multiple direct citation opportunities per page. Studies show FAQPage schema produces a 47% increase in Perplexity citations. We cover this in full in Section 5.

Section 4: Answer-first writing — the method that gets you cited

THE ANALOGY

Think of AI as a very busy editor who needs to fill space in a magazine in the next ten seconds. They don't have time to read your whole article — they need to grab a good quote. If your first sentence is a direct, quotable answer, they'll use it. If your first paragraph is context-setting, they'll move to the next article in the pile.

Answer-first writing means structuring every section so the direct answer comes first — before context, before history, before qualifications. This is the opposite of how most business websites are written, which build towards the answer rather than leading with it.

The answer-first formula

- 1 **Lead with the direct answer** — state what the answer is in the first sentence of the section
- 2 **Add the key detail** — the one most important supporting fact (a number, a timeframe, a location)
- 3 **Explain if needed** — why this is true, or what to expect
- 4 **Close with action** — what the reader should do next

This structure works at every level: for the page as a whole (the opening paragraph leads with what the business does), for individual sections (the section opening leads with the point), and for FAQ answers (the first sentence of the answer is the direct answer to the question).

Specific language that signals confidence to AI

AI tools weight content confidence. Hedged language ("we might be able to," "depending on circumstances," "in most cases") reduces the citability of a statement. Direct language ("we cover," "costs between," "takes approximately") is more likely to be extracted and used.

Before and after: rewriting for AI citability

Here are three real-world rewrites to show the before-after difference. These are the kinds of sections you'll find on most local business websites — and how to make them work for AI:

❑ BEFORE — CONTEXT-FIRST

"When you have a plumbing emergency, the last thing you want is to be kept waiting. That's why at Smith Plumbing, we've built our entire service around fast response times. We understand how stressful a burst pipe or broken boiler can be, and we do everything we can to get to you quickly."

✓ AFTER — ANSWER-FIRST

"Our emergency plumbers respond within 60 minutes across Birmingham, 24 hours a day, 7 days a week — including bank holidays. We're Gas Safe registered (ID: 543210) and carry over 200 standard parts on every van to fix most faults in a single visit."

❑ BEFORE — VAGUE CLAIM

"We've been serving the local community for many years and have built a strong reputation for quality workmanship. Our customers regularly leave us great feedback and we're proud of the service we provide."

✓ AFTER — SPECIFIC AND CITABLE

"Smith Plumbing has completed over 1,400 jobs across Birmingham since 2009. We hold a 4.9-star rating from 143 verified Google reviews. Our engineers are Gas Safe registered and fully insured up to £2M public liability."

THE PATTERN TO AVOID

Sentences that start with "We" followed by a vague positive claim ("We pride ourselves on...", "We're committed to...", "We believe in...") are almost never cited by AI. Replace them with sentences that start with a specific fact about what you do, where, or how well.

Section 5: Building a FAQ section that AI tools cite

If there's one single thing you do as a result of reading this guide, make it this: add a FAQ section with FAQPage schema to your website. It's the highest-leverage, lowest-effort structural change you can make for AI citation — and it's something most local businesses haven't done yet.

Why FAQs work so well for AI citation

AI tools are answering questions. That's their entire job. When someone asks ChatGPT "how long does a boiler service take in Birmingham?", ChatGPT searches for a direct answer to that exact question. If your website has that question in a heading and a direct, specific answer below it — and if that question-answer pair is marked up with FAQPage schema — you are the perfect citation source.

47%

increase in Perplexity citations for FAQPage schema pages

4x

more likely to be extracted by AI than equivalent non-FAQ content

How to choose your FAQ questions

The best FAQ questions come from real life — the questions customers ask you before they book. These are the same questions they're asking AI tools before they choose a business. Sources:

- Questions you get on the phone or by text repeatedly
- The Q&A section of your Google Business Profile
- One-star reviews that reveal what customers were unsure about before booking
- The "People also ask" section in Google when you search your own services
- Questions in relevant Facebook groups or Reddit threads about your trade

Writing answers AI will cite

Every FAQ answer should follow the answer-first formula: direct answer in the first sentence, then supporting detail. Aim for 2-4 sentences per answer. Long enough to be complete, short enough to be extracted as a quote.

The FAQPage schema code

Once you've written your questions and answers on the page, wrap them in FAQPage schema. Add this to your <head> alongside your LocalBusiness schema:

FAQPAGE SCHEMA — PASTE IN YOUR <HEAD>

```
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "FAQPage",
  "mainEntity": [
    {
      "@type": "Question",
      "name": "How quickly can you respond to an emergency callout?",
      "acceptedAnswer": {
        "@type": "Answer",
        "text": "Our emergency plumbers respond within 60 minutes across Birmingham. We operate 24/7 including bank holidays and weekends. Most emergency callouts – burst pipes, boiler breakdowns, gas leaks – are resolved in a single visit."
      }
    }
  ]
  // Add more Question objects here, one per FAQ
}
```

ONE SCHEMA BLOCK PER PAGE

You should have separate FAQPage schema blocks for each page that has a FAQ section — your homepage, your boiler repair page, your bathroom fitting page, etc. Each one creates its own independent citation opportunities.

Section 6: Service pages — your best AI citation assets

Your homepage catches people who search for your business by name. Your service pages catch people who search for a specific service in a specific place — and that's exactly what AI tools are matching when someone asks "who does boiler repairs in Moseley?"

A well-structured service page — one page per key service — is the most scalable way to expand your AI citation footprint. Each page creates independent citation opportunities for a different query.

What makes a service page AI-citable

- 1 Page title as a question or direct statement** — "Emergency Boiler Repair in Birmingham — Same-Day Service" or "How We Handle Gas Safety Certificates in the West Midlands"
- 2 First paragraph: answer-first about this specific service** — what it is, where you do it, how long it takes, what it costs (or a range)
- 3 Process section** — a numbered list of what happens when they book this service
- 4 Local specificity** — the specific towns and areas covered for this service
- 5 FAQ section specific to this service** — 4-6 questions customers ask about this service in particular
- 6 FAQPage schema** — wrapping the FAQ content, service-specific to this page
- 7 Specific numbers** — how many of these jobs you've done, your average rating, your response time for this specific service

START WITH ONE

Don't try to optimise every service page at once. Pick your most important service (highest revenue, most competitive, most frequently searched) and do that one first. One excellent service page produces more AI citations than five average ones.

Location-specific pages: if you cover multiple areas

If you serve multiple towns or areas, location-specific pages are a powerful way to become the best answer for "[service] in [specific town]" queries. These are pages like "Plumber in Harborne" or "Boiler Repair in Kings Heath" — each one targeting a specific geographic query.

Done well, these pages are the highest-converting pages on a local business website — because the visitor has already said exactly where they are and what they need. Done badly (thin, repetitive, stuffed with the location name), they hurt more than they help.

What a good location page includes

- **Genuinely local content** — specific references to the area, not just the town name swapped in
- **Services you specifically offer in that area** — if you do different things in different areas, say so
- **Local social proof** — quotes from or references to customers in that specific area
- **Distance and travel time from your base** — this signals AI tools about your actual service range
- **LocalBusiness schema with areaServed updated** — to include this specific town
- **FAQs specific to this area** — "Do you cover emergency callouts in Harborne?" "How quickly can you get to Kings Heath?"

AVOID THE THIN PAGE TRAP

A location page that just says "we also serve [town name]" with 50 words of content is worse than not having the page at all. AI tools penalise thin content — a page needs at least 400-500 words of genuinely useful, specific information to be worth creating.

Section 7: Your About page and trust signals

AI tools weight authority. They prefer to cite businesses that have credible, verifiable information available — businesses that feel real and established. Your About page is where many of your authority signals live.

What your About page should establish

- **Founded date and history** — "Established in 2009" or "Trading since 2009" gives AI tools a verifiable anchor point
- **Named founder or team** — real names increase credibility signals; anonymous businesses feel less citable
- **Qualifications and registrations** — list your Gas Safe number, NICEIC registration, TrustMark status, or equivalent with the registration IDs where possible
- **Specific numbers** — jobs completed, years in business, review count, areas covered
- **Real photos** — a photo of you or your team on a real job site adds credibility signals that AI tools infer from alt text and surrounding content

Person schema — for individual practitioners

If you're a sole trader or the face of the business, adding Person schema alongside your LocalBusiness schema creates an additional layer of identity verification. It links your name, qualifications, and professional URL to your business — which helps AI tools treat you as a verified individual, not just an anonymous entity.

CREDENTIALS AS TEXT, NOT IMAGES

If you display qualification badges or accreditation logos (Gas Safe, NICEIC, Federation of Master Builders), include the text of the accreditation nearby — "Gas Safe registered, number 543210" — so AI crawlers can read it. Badge images alone are invisible to them.

Section 8: How to test whether AI tools are citing your website

Unlike traditional SEO, where rank trackers tell you exactly where you appear in search results, AI citation is harder to measure. But you can test it — and you should, both now (to set a baseline) and again in 6-8 weeks (to measure improvement).

The test queries to run

Open ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Google.com (for AI Overviews) and run each of these — replacing the brackets with your details:

- 1 "Who are the best [trade] in [your town]?"
- 2 "Can you recommend a [your main service] near [your area]?"
- 3 "[Your specific FAQ question — e.g. 'How much does a boiler service cost in Birmingham?']"
- 4 "Is there a [trade] in [your town] who does [specific service]?"
- 5 Your business name directly — "Tell me about Smith Plumbing Birmingham"

What to look for in the responses

- **Are you mentioned?** — Does your business name appear in the response at all?
- **Is your website cited?** — Perplexity shows source links directly. For ChatGPT, look for your URL or business name in the sources section.
- **Is the information accurate?** — Does the AI describe your business correctly? Inaccuracies indicate which sources it's using and what those sources say.
- **Who else appears?** — Your competitors appearing here tell you what signals they have that you might be missing.

Screenshot or copy every response. These are your baseline results. After implementing the changes in this guide, re-run the same queries in 6-8 weeks and compare.

How to track improvement over time

AI visibility doesn't update overnight. Different AI tools update at different speeds:

- **Google AI Overviews** — Updates within 1-4 weeks as Google re-crawls your site. The fastest to show improvement after schema changes.
- **Perplexity** — Updates more frequently than ChatGPT, typically within 2-6 weeks of major site changes.
- **ChatGPT** — Updates on a less predictable cycle, but significant improvements (adding LocalBusiness schema, FAQ schema, major content changes) are typically reflected within 2-3 months.

A simple monthly tracking system

- 1 Create a simple spreadsheet with columns: Query, Tool, Date, Result (mentioned/not mentioned/cited/wrong info)
- 2 Run your 5 test queries in each tool on the first of every month
- 3 Record whether you appear, whether you're cited, and whether the info is accurate
- 4 Add a notes column for what changed that month (new FAQ page, schema added, etc.)
- 5 Review after 3 months — the correlation between changes and citation improvements will be visible

THE LEADING INDICATOR

Google Search Console is a good leading indicator. When you make content changes and schema additions, watch for increases in clicks and impressions for question-format queries in your area. These often precede AI citation improvements by a few weeks.

What to do if you're not appearing after 8 weeks

Return to the audit in Module 1 and re-run it. The most common blockers are: GBP still incomplete, citation inconsistencies not fully fixed, reviews velocity still low, or schema that's present but has errors. Use Google's Rich Results Test and fix any schema errors first.

Section 9: The most common website mistakes that kill AI visibility

These are the mistakes that appear consistently when you audit local business websites for AI readability. Check your own site against each one.

Mistake 1: No LocalBusiness schema at all

Still the most common. Most local business websites — even well-designed, modern ones — have zero schema markup. This is the single biggest structural gap. Fix this first.

Mistake 2: Schema present but with errors

Many businesses have schema that was auto-generated by a plugin but was never verified. Errors in schema (missing required fields, wrong address format, outdated phone number) can actively confuse AI tools. Always verify with Google's Rich Results Test after adding or updating schema.

Mistake 3: The address isn't on the homepage

AI tools cross-reference your website address against your GBP. If there's no address on your homepage, they can't complete the verification. Add it in the footer and in your schema.

Mistake 4: Service descriptions are too vague

"We provide all types of plumbing services" is useless to an AI tool matching a specific service query. "We provide emergency boiler repair, central heating installation, gas safety certificates, and bathroom fitting across Birmingham" is a specific, matchable service list.

Mistake 5: No question-format content anywhere

If none of your headings are questions, none of your sections are directly matchable to question-format AI queries. Add at least one FAQ section to your homepage and each key service page.

THE BIGGEST MISTAKE OF ALL

Making all these changes to your website and never testing whether AI tools can see the difference. Build testing into your process from day one — it's the only way to know what's working.

Section 10: How your website fits into the complete AI visibility picture

Throughout this series, we've built your AI visibility from the ground up. This final section shows how all five modules work together — because your website optimisation is most effective when it's supported by everything else.

THE COMPLETE PICTURE

Think of your AI visibility as a five-legged stool. Each leg is a module. Your GBP is the primary leg — the one that takes the most weight. Your citations are the stability leg — everything falls sideways without it. Your reviews are the social proof leg — they push you above equally-optimised competitors. Your website structure is the authority leg — it's what AI tools check to confirm you're real and credible. All five together create something stable. Remove one and the stool wobbles.

The compounding effect

Each module in this series creates improvements on its own. But the biggest gains come when all five are working together. A complete GBP pointing to a schema-rich website, backed by 50 detailed Google reviews, with consistent NAP across 12 directories — that's a business that AI tools cite with confidence, repeatedly, for years.

- **Module 1** gave you the strategic understanding of why this matters now
- **Module 2** built the foundation — a complete, optimised GBP
- **Module 3** created trust through NAP consistency
- **Module 4** built your social proof through reviews
- **Module 5** (this module) has made your website an AI citation machine

The work isn't done — AI search continues to evolve and what works today may need to adapt tomorrow. But the fundamentals you've built in this series are lasting: clear information, consistent presence, quality signals, and content that answers real questions directly. Those will always matter to AI tools, because they'll always matter to the humans behind the questions.

Module 5 — Quick Wins Checklist

These are the actions from this module, roughly ordered by impact. Work through them this week.

- ☐ **Add LocalBusiness schema to your homepage** — copy the template from Section 2, fill in your details, and add it to your <head> tag today
- ☐ **Verify your schema** — run your site through Google's Rich Results Test at search.google.com/test/rich-results and fix any errors
- ☐ **Rewrite your opening paragraph** — make the first two sentences of your homepage answer "who, what, where" directly and specifically
- ☐ **Add visible NAP text** — make sure your full name, address (matching GBP), and phone number appear as HTML text on your homepage
- ☐ **List your services specifically** — replace vague service descriptions with a named list of the actual services you provide
- ☐ **Add at least 3 specific numbers** — years in business, job count, review score, response time, or qualification registration number
- ☐ **Write 5-8 FAQ questions and answers** — from real questions customers ask you, with direct answer-first answers
- ☐ **Add FAQPage schema** — wrap your FAQ content in FAQPage JSON-LD following the template in Section 5
- ☐ **Run your baseline AI test** — test 5 queries in ChatGPT and Perplexity now, screenshot the results, set a reminder to re-test in 8 weeks
- ☐ **Add areaServed to your schema** — list every town and area you cover so AI tools can match you to location-specific queries

Resources mentioned in this module

Testing and validation

- **Google Rich Results Test** — search.google.com/test/rich-results — validates your schema and identifies errors
- **Schema.org** — schema.org/LocalBusiness — the full list of supported properties for LocalBusiness schema
- **Google Search Console** — search.google.com/search-console — monitor clicks and impressions for question-format queries

Schema generation tools

- **Yoast SEO** (WordPress plugin) — yoast.com — generates LocalBusiness schema from settings
- **Rank Math** (WordPress plugin) — rankmath.com — comprehensive schema generation including LocalBusiness and FAQ
- **Schema Pro** (WordPress plugin) — wpschema.com — paid plugin with full control over all schema types

AI tools to test your visibility

- **ChatGPT** — chat.openai.com — free tier sufficient for testing
- **Perplexity** — perplexity.ai — shows citations directly, excellent for verifying your content is being pulled
- **Google AI Overviews** — google.com — AI summaries now appear for many local service queries
- **Microsoft Copilot** — copilot.microsoft.com — powered by Bing data; good indicator of Bing Places effectiveness

Continue learning

- **AI Search School** — aisearchschool.com — free articles on AI visibility updated regularly
- **AI Search School Community** — Skool community for questions and peer learning (free)
- **WeLaunchd** — welaunchd.com — done-for-you websites with all five modules built in

You've completed the series.

This is the final module in the "Get Found in AI Local Search" series. If you've worked through all five modules and implemented what each one covered, you now have:

- A complete, fully optimised Google Business Profile
- Consistent NAP across every directory that matters
- A review collection system generating regular, quality reviews
- A website with LocalBusiness schema, FAQPage schema, and answer-first content
- A tested baseline and a monthly tracking system to measure your improvement

That's more than 90% of local businesses have done. The work now is maintenance and iteration — keeping your GBP updated, keeping reviews flowing, testing AI responses monthly, and refining your content when you see opportunities.

WHAT COMES NEXT?

Stay ahead as AI search evolves

AI search is changing fast. New models, new citation patterns, new schema types being adopted. AI Search School publishes free articles every week tracking what's working — and new guide series on specific topics (reviews deep-dives, schema advanced techniques, Perplexity-specific strategies). Stay connected at aisearchschool.com and in the free community on Skool.

Five modules. One complete transformation.

Each module tackles one pillar of AI local visibility — buy them individually or as a bundle and work through them in order.

1

Why Local Search Is Going AI

Understanding the shift and why now is the time to act

2

Your Google Business Profile — Set Up for the AI Era

The primary AI signal, optimised from scratch

3

NAP Consistency — How to Make Every Directory Work Together

The trust foundation every other signal depends on

4

Reviews That Actually Get You Found — and Chosen

Collecting, responding, and making reviews work for AI

5

Your Website as an AI Signal ← You are here

Schema, structure, and content that gets you cited

All five modules available at welaunchd.store · £9 each · £29 as a bundle